

Voice Restructuring in Korean Psych Adjectives

NOM-ACC Case Alternation Without Long Object Movement

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1.1. Case Alternation in Korean Psych Adjectives

- (1) a. Na-nun **sakwa-ka/-lul** mek-ko **siph-ta.**
I-TOP **apple-NOM/-ACC** eat-KO **want-DECL**
'I want to eat an apple.'
- b. Na-nun **sakwa-ka/-lul** mek-ki **silh/mwusep-ta.**
I-TOP **apple-NOM/-ACC** eat-KI **dislike/be.afraid.of-DECL**
'I hate to eat/am afraid of eating an apple.'
- (2) Na-nun **sakwa-(ka*)/-lul** **mek-nun-ta.**
I-TOP **apple-NOM/-ACC** **eat-PRS-DECL.**
'I eat an apple.'
- A subset of Korean psych adjectives exhibit NOM-ACC case alternation when they select embedded predicates.
 - The object can optionally take nominative case (1), which is not possible in an unembedded environment (2).

1.2. Agent-Oriented Adverb Modification

Compatibility with agent-oriented adverbs

- (3) a. Na-nun **sonswu/ilpwule** **cip(-i*)/-ul** cis-ko siph-ess-ta.
 I-TOP **with.own.hands/on.purpose** **house-NOM/-ACC** build-KO want-PST-DECL
Intended: 'I wanted to build a house with my own hands/on purpose.'
- b. Na-nun **sonswu/ilpwule** **cip(-i*)/-ul** cis-ki silh-ess-ta.
 I-TOP **with.own.hands/on.purpose** **house-NOM/-ACC** build-KI dislike-PST-DECL
Intended: 'I hated to build a house with my own hands/on purpose.'

- Agent-oriented adverbs like **sonswu** 'with one's own hands' or **ilpwule** 'on purpose' are restricted to the Accusative Object Construction only.

1.3 Time Modification and Embedded Progressive Aspect

Compatibility with time adverbs

- (4) Na-nun **phyenci(?-ka)/-lul** **nayil** ssu-ko siph-ess-ta.
I-TOP **letter-NOM/-ACC** **tomorrow** write-KO want-PST-DECL

'I wanted to write a letter tomorrow.'

Intended: The adverb tomorrow modifies the writing event, independently of wanting.

Progressive aspect marker *-ko iss*

- (5) a. Na-nun **chayk(-i*)/-ul** ilk-**ko iss**-ko siph-ta.
I-TOP **book-NOM/-ACC** read-**PROG**-KO want-DECL

'I want to be reading a book'

- b. Na-nun **chayk(-i*)/-ul** ilk-**ko iss**-ki silh-ta.
I-TOP **book-NOM/-ACC** read-**PROG**-KI dislike-DECL

'I do not want to be reading a book.'

1.4. Duration Modification and Non-Finiteness

Event duration modification

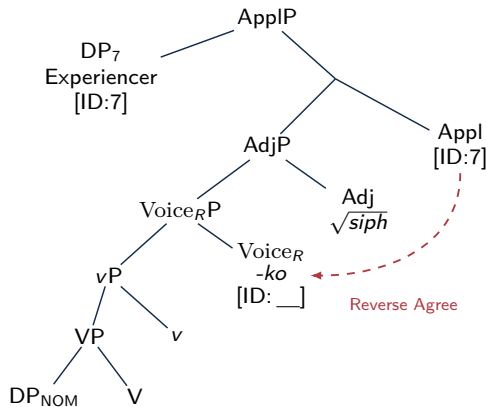
- (6) Na-nun **cam-i/-ul** **sip** **pwun** **tongan** ca-ko siph-ess-ta.
 I-TOP **sleep-NOM/-ACC** **ten** **minute** **for** sleep-KO want-PST-DECL
'I wanted to sleep for ten minutes.'

Embedded finite tense marking

- (7) a. Na-nun **sakwa-ka/-lul** mek-ko siph-**ess**-ta.
 I-TOP **apple-NOM/-ACC** eat-KO want-**PST**-DECL
'I wanted to eat an apple.'
- b. *Na-nun **sakwa-ka/-lul** mek-**ess**-ko siph-ta.
 I-TOP **apple-NOM/-ACC** eat-**PST**-KO want-DECL
Intended: 'I want to have eaten an apple.'

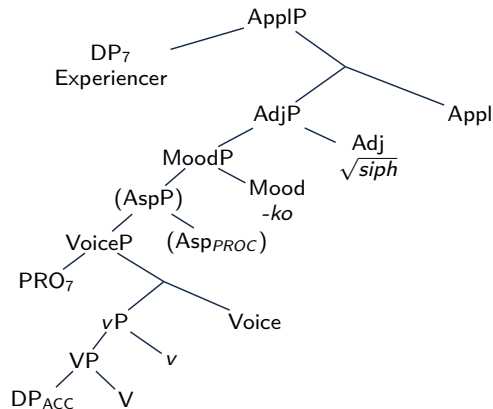
2.1. Complement Size Difference Under a Lexical Adjective

Voice Restructuring (NOM-marked object)



- (8) Na-nun **sakwa-ka** mek-ko siph-ta.
I-TOP **apple-NOM** eat-KO want-DECL
'I want to eat an apple.'

Non-Restructuring (ACC-marked object)



- (9) Na-nun **sakwa-lul** mek-ko siph-ta.
I-TOP **apple-ACC** eat-KO want-DECL
'I want to eat an apple.'

2.2. Voice Restructuring and Reverse Agree

Voice restructuring (Wurmbrand 2014, Wurmbrand & Shimamura 2017)

- The embedded Voice_RP contains deficient Voice_R and no projected external argument PRO.
- From the start of the derivation, Appl has the experiencer's valued [ID] feature, whereas Voice_R bears an unvalued [ID: __] feature.

Reverse Agree (Bryant, Kovač & Wurmbrand 2023)

- **Reverse Agree:** A higher element supplies an ID value to an accessible, c-commanded lower head.

$$\underbrace{\text{DP}_7[\text{ID} : 7]}_{\text{experiencer}} \quad \& \quad \text{Appl}[\text{ID} : 7] \longrightarrow \text{Voice}_R[\text{ID} : _ \mapsto 7]$$

- In the NOC, the shared index identifies the embedded understood agent with the matrix experiencer, without the help of PRO.

2.3. Dependent Case Theory and the NOM–ACC alternation

NOM as a Default case & ACC as a Dependent case

- **CP and VoiceP are case domains.**
- Within a case domain, an eligible nominal receives dependent ACC when another case competitor c-commands it.

Nominative Object Construction (Voice Restructuring)

$$[Voice_R P \ [_{\nu P} DP_{NOM} V] \ Voice_R]$$

- With **no PRO**, there is no local case competition and **no dependent ACC**.

Accusative Object Construction (Non-Restructuring)

$$[Voice_P \ PRO_i \ [_{\nu P} DP_{ACC} V] \ Voice]$$

- **PRO** c-commands the object within the same VoiceP case domain, allowing the object **to receive ACC**.

3.1. Adjectival Adnominal Morphology

- (10) a. **coh-un** / *coh-nun chayk
 good-ADN / good-ADN.PRS.V book
 'a good book'
- b. *ilk-un / **ilk-nun** chayk
 read-ADN / **read-ADN.PRS.V** book
 'a book that (someone) is reading'
- (11) a. ilk-ko **siph-un** / *siph-nun chayk
 read-KO **want-ADN** / want-ADN.PRS.V book
 'a book that (I) want to read'
- b. ilk-ki **silh-un** / *silh-nun chayk
 read-KI **dislike-ADN** / dislike-ADN.PRS.V book
 'a book that (I) do not want to read'

- In Korean, verbs and adjectives take different adnominal markers (10).
- In a present-state reading, restructuring psych adjectives take the adjectival marker *-un* (11). The embedded verb *ilk* 'to read' does not determine the choice of adnominal marker.

3.2. Sentence-final Tense and Aspect

- (12) a. Na-nun **chayk-i/-ul** ilk-ko **siph-∅-ta** / *siph-nun-ta.
 I-TOP **book-NOM/-ACC** read-KO **want-PRS.Adj-DECL** / want-PRS.V-DECL
'I want to read a book.'
- b. Na-nun **chayk-i/-ul** ilk-ki **silh-∅-ta** / *silh-nun-ta.
 I-TOP **book-NOM/-ACC** read-KI **dislike-PRS.Adj-DECL** / dislike-PRS.V-DECL
'I do not want to read a book.'

Class	-nun (PRS)	-ess/-ass (PST)	-ko iss- (PROG)
Verb	✓	✓	✓
Adjective	*	✓	*
Restructuring psych adjective	*	✓	*

3.3. -e ha Verbalization and Lexical Status

(13) a. Na-nun **sulph**-ta.
I-TOP **sad**-DECL
'I am sad.'

b. Na-nun **sulph-e ha**-n-ta.
I-TOP **sad-VBLZ**-PRS-DECL
'I feel sad.'

(14) a. Mina-nun chayk-ul ilk-ko **siph-e ha**-n-ta.
Mina-TOP book-ACC read-KO **want-VBLZ**-PRS-DECL
'Mina wants to read a book.'

b. *Mina-nun koylop-e **ya ha-e ha**-n-ta.
Mina-TOP be.in.distress-**MOD-VBLZ**-PRS-DECL
Intended: 'Mina has to feel distressed.'

c. *Mina-nun oylop-e **to toy-e ha**-n-ta.
Mina-TOP lonely-**MOD-VBLZ**-PRS-DECL
Intended: 'Mina is allowed to feel lonely.'

- Like lexical psych adjectives (13), restructuring psych adjectives allow -e ha verbalization (14a), supporting their **lexical status**.
- Periphrastic modals block this verbalization when they intervene (14b–c).

3.4. Variation in Morphological Integration

Adverb insertion

- (15) a. *Na-nun pap-i mek-ko **cengmal** siph-ta.
 I-TOP meal-NOM eat-KO **really** want-DECL
Intended: 'I really want to eat a meal.'
- b. Na-nun pap-i mek-ki **cengmal** silh-ta.
 I-TOP meal-NOM eat-KI **really** dislike-DECL
'I really do not want to eat a meal.'

Case marking on the complement

- (16) a. *Na-nun cip-ey ka-ko-ka siph-ta.
 I-TOP home-LOC go-KO-NOM want-DECL
Intended: 'I want to go home.'
- b. Na-nun cip-ey ka-ki-ka silh-ta.
 I-TOP home-LOC go-KI-NOM dislike-DECL
'I do not want to go home.'

3.5. Variation in Selectional Property

Availability of a *-kes* clause

- (17) a. *Na-nun [Mina-ka ttena-n **kes-i**] **siph**-ess-ta.
 I-TOP Mina-NOM leave-ADN **KES**-NOM **want**-PST-DECL
Intended: 'I wanted Mina to have left.'
- b. Na-nun [Mina-ka ttena-n **kes-i**] **silh**-ess-ta.
 I-TOP Mina-NOM leave-ADN **KES**-NOM **dislike**-PST-DECL
'I disliked the fact that Mina had left.'

Availability of a nominal object

- (18) a. *Na-nun **Mina-ka** **siph**-ta.
 I-TOP **Mina-NOM** want-DECL
Intended: 'I want Mina.'
- b. Na-nun **Mina-ka** **silh**-ta.
 I-TOP **Mina-NOM** dislike-DECL
'I dislike Mina.'

- But **the restructuring effects cut across this class-internal variation** in lexical integrity
- The suffixal status of *-siph* 'to want' is largely irrelevant to the restructuring pattern.

4.1. Lack of Subject Experiencer Verb Effect

- (19) a. I hate dogs. Generic; #nonspecific existential
 b. I hate some dogs. Specific individuals or specific subkinds

- (20) a. *?Na-nun **salam-i** **han-myeng** mwusep-ess-ta.
 I-TOP **person-NOM** **one-CL** be.afraid.of-PST-DECL

Intended: 'I feared one person.'

Case-medial order: nonspecific reading required, which is unacceptable here.

- b. Na-nun **salam** **han-myeng-i** mwusep-ess-ta.
 I-TOP **person** **one-CL-NOM** be.afraid.of-PST-DECL

'I feared a certain person.'

Case-final order: specific reading only with the psych adjective *mwusep* 'to be afraid'.

- As Seres and Espinal (2018) point out, **subject experiencer verbs cross-linguistically restrict existential readings of their objects** (19).
- Korean simplex psych adjectives show a parallel restriction. **Case-medial order** permits only an existential reading, which **is incompatible with this context** (20a). **Case-final order** normally permits both readings, but *mwusep* 'to be afraid' **rules out the existential reading** in (20b).

4.1. Lack of Subject Experiencer Verb Effect

- (21) a. Na-nun **salam-ul/-i** **han-myeng** manna-ki **mwusep**-ess-ta.
 I-TOP **person-ACC/-NOM** **one-CL** meet-KI **be.afraid.of**-PST-DECL
'I was afraid of meeting one person, not any particular person.'

Case-medial order: nonspecific existential reading with both ACC and NOM.

- b. Na-nun **salam** **han-myeng-ul/-i** manna-ki **mwusep**-ess-ta.
 I-TOP **person** **one-CL-ACC/-NOM** meet-KI **be.afraid.of**-PST-DECL
'I was afraid of meeting one person.'

Case-final order: specific or nonspecific existential reading with either case.

- The embedded object of restructuring psych adjective constructions escapes this restriction (21).
- This evidence argues against an analysis in which restructuring psych adjectives directly select the embedded object.

4.2. Person Restriction On the Experiencer Subject

- (22) a. **Na-nun / #Mina-nun** pap-ul mek-ko **siph-ta.**
I-TOP / Mina-TOP meal-ACC eat-KO **want-DECL**
'I want to eat.' / #'Mina wants to eat.'
- b. **Na-nun / #Mina-nun** pap-ul mek-ki **silh-ta.**
I-TOP / Mina-TOP meal-ACC eat-KI **dislike-DECL**
'I do not want to eat.' / #'Mina does not want to eat.'

C.-M. Lee (2013)

- (23) a. **Ne-nun / #Mina-nun** pap-ul mek-ko **siph-ni?**
you-TOP / Mina-TOP meal-ACC eat-KO **want-Q**
'Do you want to eat?' / #'Does Mina want to eat?'
- b. **Mina-nun** pap-ul mek-ko **siph-tay.**
Mina-TOP meal-ACC eat-KO **want-REP**
'Mina reportedly wants to eat.'

- Restructuring psych adjectives *siph* and *silh* show a **person restriction** on the **experiencer subject** (22–23).
- This person restriction on the subject argument supports **control** over raising analysis.

5.1. Anti-Reconstruction Effect in NOC

- (24) a. Na-nun **sakwa-man-ul** mek-ko **siph-ta**.
 I-TOP **apple-ONLY-ACC** eat-KO **want-DECL**
'I want to eat only apples.'

✓ WANT > ONLY ✓ ONLY > WANT

- b. Na-nun **sakwa-man-i** mek-ko **siph-ta**.
 I-TOP **apple-ONLY-NOM** eat-KO **want-DECL**
'Apples are the only things I want to eat.'

*WANT > ONLY ✓ ONLY > WANT

Lee (2023: 72–75), (78)–(82)

- One possible objection concerns the **anti-reconstruction effect** in the NOC (24b). The nominative object allows only a high scope reading unlike non-restructuring AOC (24a).
- **Possible solution:** case is licensed in situ while **QR at LF** can require high scope if no lower interpretation site is available.

5.1. Anti-Reconstruction Effect in NOC

- (24) c. Na-nun **manhun salamtul-ul** manna-ko siph-ci **an**-h-ta.
 I-TOP **many people-ACC** meet-KO want-CI **NEG**-do-DECL
'I do not want to meet many people.'

✓ NEG > MANY ✓ MANY > NEG

- (24) d. Na-nun **manhun salamtul-i** manna-ko siph-ci **an**-h-ta.
 I-TOP **many people-NOM** meet-KO want-CI **NEG**-do-DECL
'There are many people I do not want to meet.'

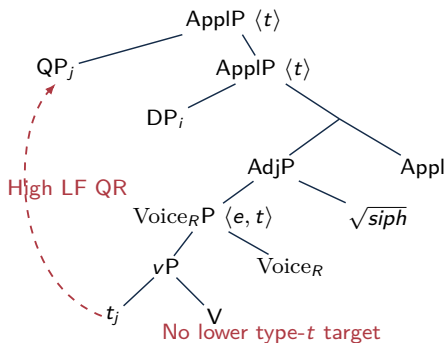
*NEG > MANY ✓ MANY > NEG

Choi (2009), reported in Lee (2023: 72–73), (78)–(79).

- With ACC, *many* can take scope above or below negation. With NOM, only wide scope is available.

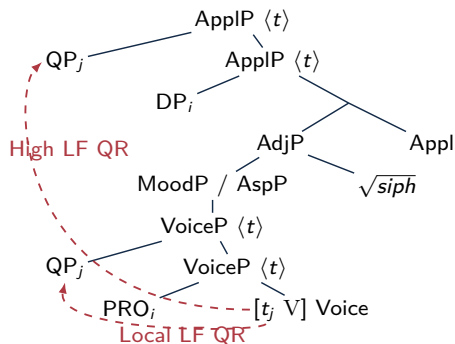
5.2. Voice Structure Shapes Case and Scope Facts

NOC (Restructuring)



No embedded subject. The lower predicate remains of type $\langle e, t \rangle$. QR must reach the matrix proposition, above the adjectival predicate *siph* 'want'

AOC (Non-Restructuring)



With PRO, the lower VoiceP denotes a proposition of type $\langle t \rangle$. Local QR gives low scope, while QR to the matrix proposition gives high scope.

5.3. Restructuring diagnostics in Korean

Diagnostic	Korean and its implication
Clitic climbing	No comparable Romance-type object-clitic climbing diagnostic.
Cross-clausal scrambling	Can cross a full finite CP, and therefore not restricted to a deficient complement.

Typological framing follows Wurmbrand (2014)

- (25) **Chayk-ul_j** na-nun [**CP** Mina-ka *t_j* ilk-ess-ta-ko] **sayngkakha-n-ta.**
book-ACC I-TOP [**Mina-NOM** read-PST-DECL-C] **think-PRS-DECL**
'This book, I think that Mina read.'

- A subject, past tense, and overt C show a **full CP status** (25). Extraction across it does not diagnose typical restructuring phenomena.
- The most plausible typological approach is to use case patterns and other evidence to identify a reduced Voice domain, a precondition for Voice restructuring phenomena.

5.4. Voice restructuring without long object movement

Japanese Long Passive

- (26) **Hanbaagaa-ga** kodomo-ni atae-tsuzuke-**rare**-ta.
hamburger-NOM child-DAT give-continue-**PASS**-PST
'Hamburgers continued to be given to children.'

Shimamura & Wurmbrand (2014)

Long passive not attested in Korean

- (27) a. Chelswu-ka **ku chayk-ul** ilk-ki sicak-**ha**-yess-ta.
 Chelswu-NOM **that book-ACC** read-KI begin-**ACT**-PST-DECL
'Chelswu began to read that book.'
- b. ***Ku chayk-i** ilk-ki sicak-**toy**-ess-ta.
that book-NOM read-KI begin-**PASS**-PST-DECL
Intended long passive: 'That book was begun to be read.'

- However, the absence of long object movement does not necessarily rule out a Voice Restructuring analysis, since Voice_R can be unavailable in the verbal domain for independent reasons in Korean.

5.5. Desiderative *-tai* in Japanese, a possible connection?

- (28) a. Watasi-wa hon-ga/-o **yomi-tai.**
I-TOP book-NOM/-ACC **read-DES-ADJ.NPST**
'I want to read a book.'
- b. Hon-ga **yomi-tsuzuke-rare-ta.**
book-NOM **read-continue-PASS-PST**
'The book continued to be read.'

Constructed pair; Ohtani & Steedman (2008: 290) and Shimamura & Wurmbrand (2014).

- Restructuring effects similar to those of Korean psych adjectives are observed in the Japanese *-tai* desiderative construction in case alternation (28a), scope interpretation (Kubota 2007) and adverbial modification (Ohtani & Steedman 2008).
- The same conjunctive form appears in both the *-tai* construction (28a) and the long passive construction (28b). Long passivization requires high scope of *dake* 'only' (Fukuda 2012), paralleling the scope behavior of NOC *-tai*, though their relation remains to be investigated.

6. Conclusion

- 1 **Complement size** The NOC contains deficient Voice_R without PRO. The AOC contains a full VoiceP with PRO, as well as MoodP and optionally AspP above it.
- 2 **Adjectival control** Psych adjectives such as *siph* 'want' and *silh* 'dislike' select a matrix subject experiencer. In the NOC, Reverse Agree identifies this experiencer with the understood embedded agent, leading to a typical Voice restructuring effect.
- 3 **Case and scope** Without a local case competitor, the NOC object receives default NOM. In the AOC, PRO serves as a local competitor, and the object receives dependent ACC. The type mismatch arising from this difference also explains the otherwise puzzling scope facts.
- 4 **Typological generalization.** Japanese exhibits NOM–ACC alternation with psych adjectives and long passives in the verbal domain, while Korean lacks the latter. Future work should explain this contrast within a typology of Voice restructuring.

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